FIND NOWHERE

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Team: All About the Numbers

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Executive Summary

Elevator Pitch

A cooperative game about being stranded on a mysterious island and surviving The Monster that inhabits it.

High Concept

Find Nowhere is a game where players gather resources on an ever changing island to prepare for battle with a Monster that will be slowly discovered over the course of the game.

Genre/Category

Adventure, Strategy, Horror, Mystery, and Cooperative Board Game.

Setting/Narrative Overview

This game takes place on a mysterious, temperate, and hilly jungle island in an indeterminate location, with no other land visible on the horizon. Players arrive through unexplainable means, such as Bermuda Triangle anomalies, plane crashes, or amnesia. Secrets and dangers obscure The Island, but its mysteries are revealed dynamically by cards and events throughout the game. The environment is both a puzzle to solve and a threat to survival as players work together to uncover its hidden truths while preparing for an eventual confrontation with The Monster overseeing The Island.

Target Audience

Find Nowhere is intended for older teens and up due to the complexity of its mechanics. The game is intended for teens and adults, approximately ages 15 to 30. This game is geared towards people who enjoy social co-op games, tabletops, core gamers, and will be enjoyed by mystery enthusiasts and horror lovers.

Play Value

The main play value of the game is the feeling of mystery and surprise, tensions slowly building up to a suspenseful final confrontation with The Monster. The game is supposed to feel immersive and challenging, with many interesting decisions to make in

your limited time. There is always the risk of dying to The Island's whims or losing the entire game during the all encompassing final battle.

Competition

This game is similar to *Eldritch Horro*r and *Arkham Horror,* both in mechanics and genre. Just like these games, *Find Nowhere* is a cooperative game where you seek to stop an overwhelming threat by traveling a board, resolving card effects, and gathering items.

Uniqueness

Find Nowhere differentiates itself from other co-op board games with its Monster evidence mechanic and its unique setting. Over the course of the game, players will be doing their best to discover evidence as to how The Monster functions, effectively building The Monster over the course of the game. The Island also changes and evolves over the course of the game, adding to the feeling of mystery and discovery.

Theming

Our game provides scaffolding for an emergent narrative that is created over the course of the game. Each game of *Find Nowhere* is a unique story about a different group of survivors working together to try and defeat a different Monster. Each Event and Encounter card are plot points in Characters' journeys, changing their goals or affecting them in different ways. Monster Actions are discovered over the course of the game, literally building The Monster until the climactic final fight. Preparing early reflects the Characters being prepared for The Monster in some way. Differing goals on the map also keep Characters moving around, providing room for more player to player interaction, which further develops the story.

Ideal Play Session

Jack Shepherd starts the game by browsing through a few Characters, gravitating towards the doctor for his ability to heal other players. As the players begin to spread out around the board, he wonders what secrets the island might hold, and what the Monster is like. When the Encounter cards are drawn, he waits anxiously to see if his Encounter will work out in his favor. Then, when the Event card is drawn, he is shocked at what has occurred. He must completely change his plan for the next turn in response. As the next couple rounds progress, he makes his way to a Preparation token, and gathers items. At the

end of the round, he draws a Monster Action, and ponders what the Monster Action Card could mean mechanically. How will he prepare?

Inspirational Media

Eldritch Horror

Genre:

Adventure, Fighting, Horror, Novel-based, and Travel.

Gameplay:

Players take on the roles of investigators traveling the globe, solving mysteries, and battling cosmic horrors to prevent an Ancient One from awakening and destroying the world.

Resources:

Items, Tickets, Health, Sanity, Clue tokens, Allies, and Spells.

Obstacles:

Portals, Monsters, Mythos effects, Condition cards, Randomness, Delayed/Detained status, and Rumors.

Play Value:

Eldritch Horror's gameplay allows for high replayability, from its variety of investigators, bosses, and random events and immersive storytelling. The game creates a deep horror adventure that makes players truly feel like they are unraveling ancient mysteries and battling cosmic forces.

Inspirations for Our Game:

- Different card decks (Items, Encounters, and so forth)
- D6 die and hit conditions (5 & 6)
- Doom tracker
- Trading resources
- Resource management

LOST

Media Type:

TV Show.

Setting/Narrative:

The story begins with Oceanic Airlines Flight 815 crashing into a remote island in the South Pacific. The survivors must find ways to coexist and survive as they try to make sense of their strange and increasingly dangerous surroundings. However, the island is far from ordinary—it is filled with mysteries, inexplicable occurrences, and hidden dangers.

Throughout the show, it becomes apparent that the island is central to the fates of the survivors, with elements of time travel, the supernatural, and complicated backstories driving the plot forward

Inspirations for Our Game:

- Map
- Setting

The Twilight Zone

Media Type:

TV Show.

Setting/Narrative:

The Twilight Zone is a science fiction anthology series that features ordinary people in extraordinary situations. Episodes often explore themes of conformity, dystopian societies, and the human condition.

Inspirations for Our Game:

- Variety of theming
- Mystery and intrigue
- Tone

Gravity Falls

Media Type:

Animated television series.

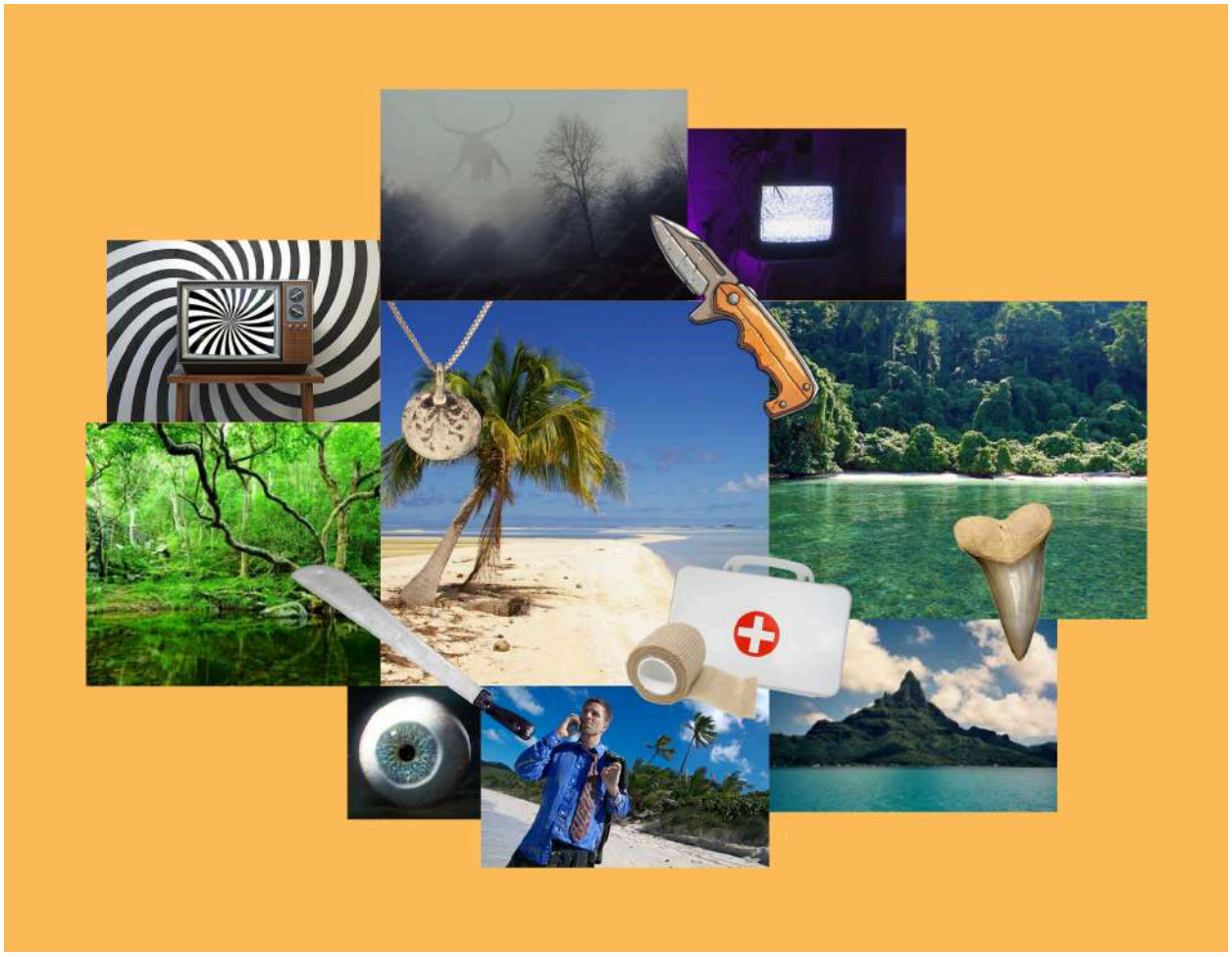
Setting/Narrative:

The series begins when Dipper and Mabel are sent to Gravity Falls to live with their great-uncle Stan, who runs a run-down tourist trap called the Mystery Shack. The twins quickly realize that Gravity Falls is no ordinary town, as they begin to encounter strange creatures, secret societies, and hidden mysteries.

Inspirations for Our Game:

- Variety of mysteries

Mood Board



Design

Reference Arts

(1)

(2)

(3)

(4)

(5)

(6)

(7)

+25%
DUNGEON
-25%
THOKHALL
lvl 3
life : 40/40
morale : 27/40
Speed : 106
Power : 86
Physical
Nature
Air
Target : Frost
Inflicts 30 dmg Physical and Bleeding
Bleeding : 15 dmg Physical / turn
Target : Aoe
Inflicts 10 dmg Nature and Poison
Poison : 11 dmg Nature / turn
(8)

(9)

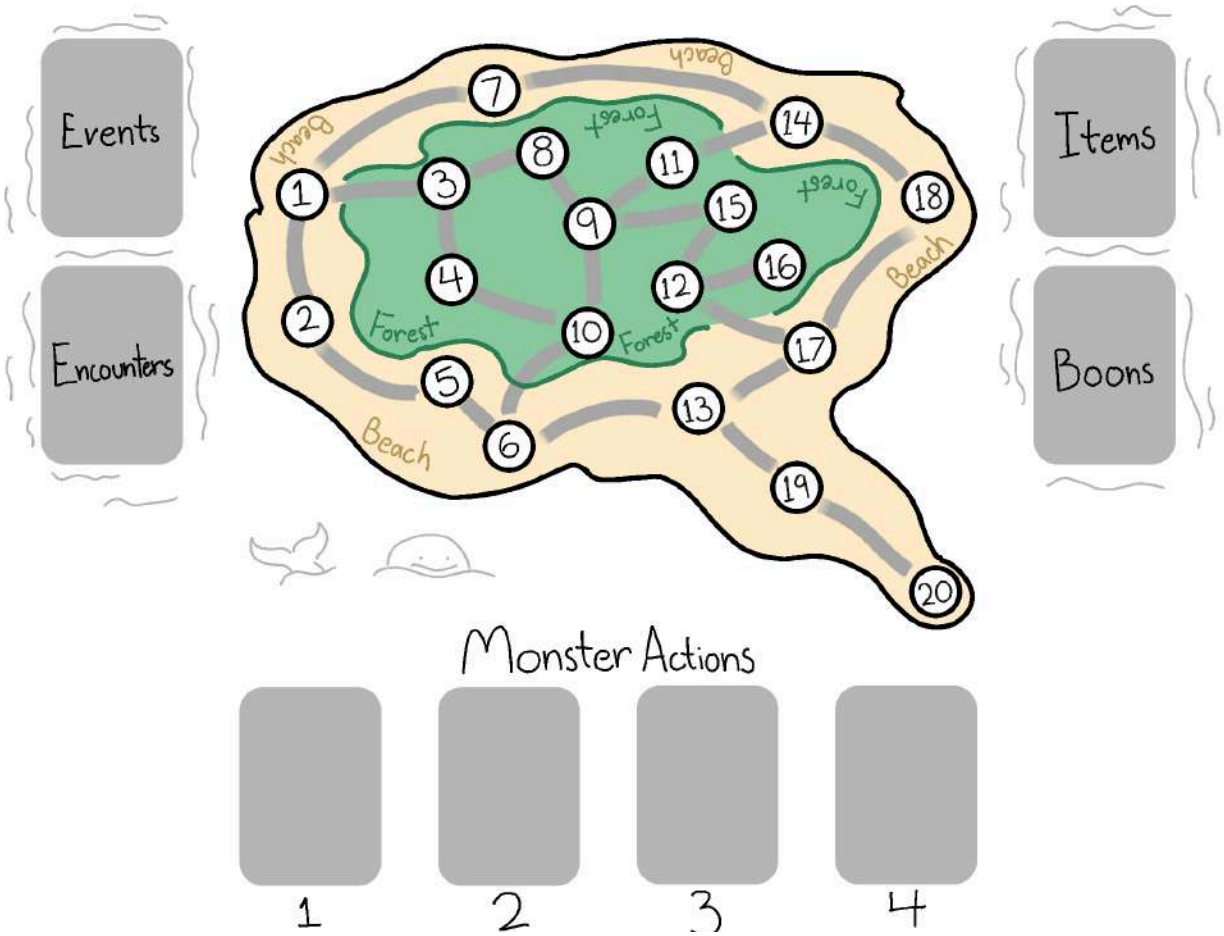
(10)

Sources

1. Created by matty17art (https://www.deviantart.com/matty17art/art/mysterious-island-391449074)
2. Created by Matt Bailey (https://www.dawnfireart.com/portfolio/Monster-concept)
3. Created by RaZuM_inc (Ilya Tulyakov) (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=x8hB_QHL1WM)
4. Created by aaronsimscompany (https://www.deviantart.com/aaronsimscompany/art/Forest-Tethered-Islands-80559802)
5. Created by Artur Sadlos (https://conceptartworld.com/news/dead-island-concept-art-by-artur-sadlos/)
6. Created by Ashish Sathe (https://www.artstation.com/artwork/lx5lk0)
7. Created by Amit Rane (https://www.artstation.com/artwork/YeyARY)
8. Created by jverbroucht (https://www.reddit.com/r/PixelArt/comments/amcqhw/concept_or_turn_based_fight_with_list_order_on/)
9. Created by Jon Ben (https://boardgamegeek.com/image/1735714/eldritch-horror)
10. Created by Alejandro T. Castellanos (https://www.artstation.com/artwork/KrKBnx)

Visual Style

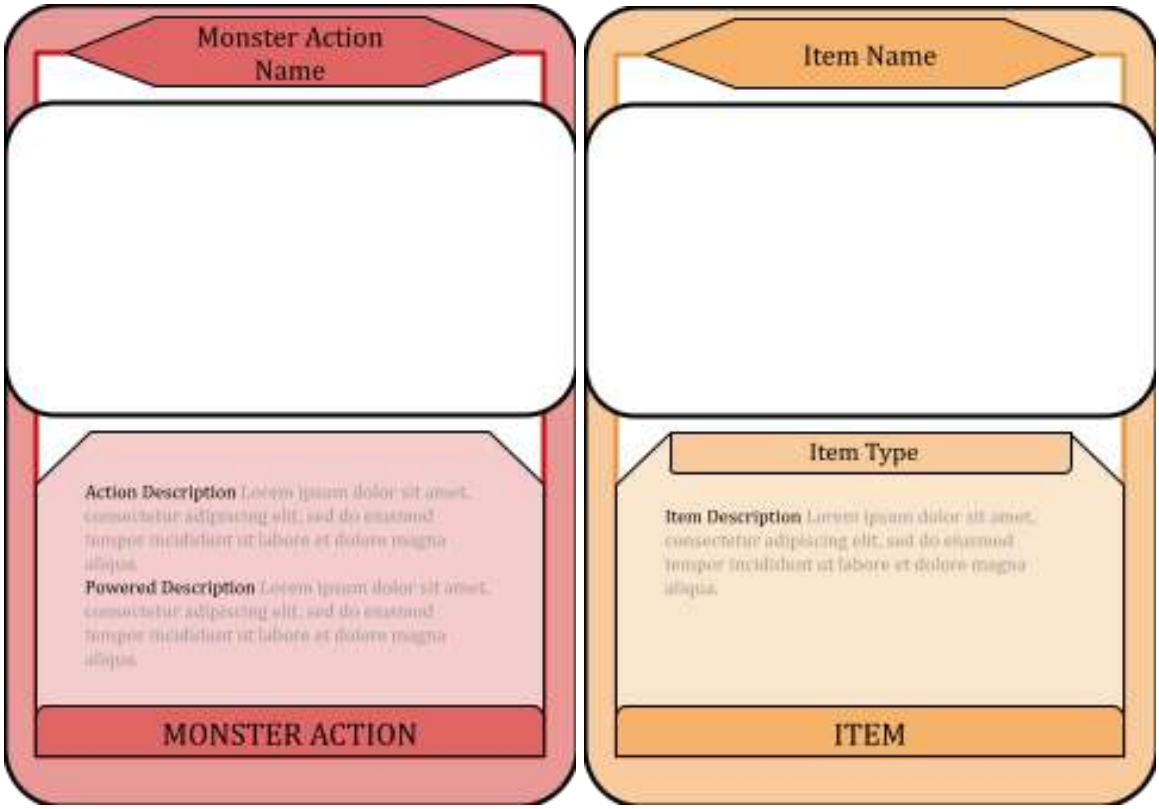
Set Up

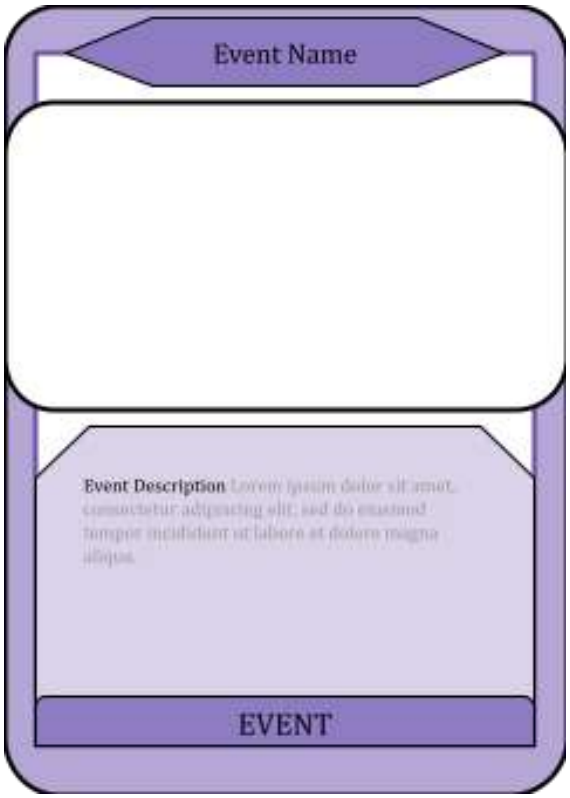


Card Templates

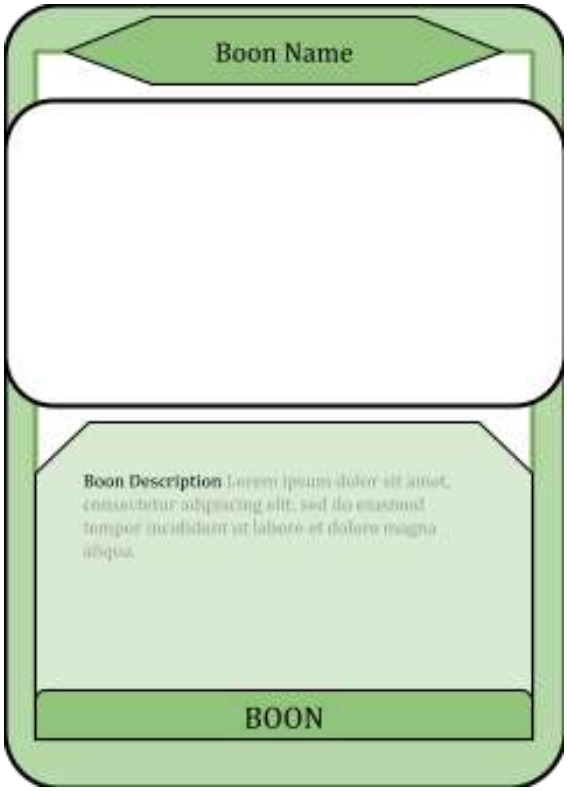
Character Card (Front & Back)

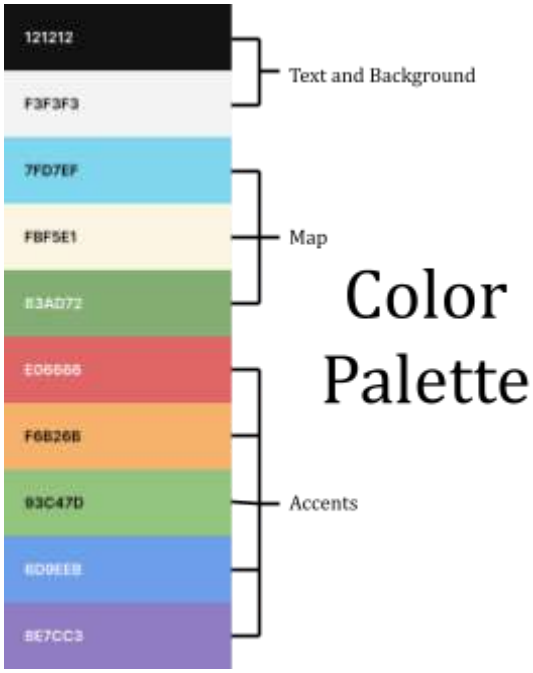
Other Card Decks (Monster Actions, Items, Events, Encounters, & Boons)




Event Name
Event Description Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua.
EVENT

Encounter Name
Encounter Description Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua.
ENCOUNTER


Boon Name
Boon Description Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua.
BOON


121212
F3F3F3
Text and Background
7FD7EF
FBF5E1
83AD72
Map
E06666
F6B26B
93C47D
6D9EEB
8E7CC3
Accents
Color Palette

Core Gameplays & Mechanics

Monster Generation

The Monster will be generated over the course of the game as players discover evidence. The Monster will always have 4 Monster Action cards which represent traits of The Monster. They are revealed during the Discovery phase. During combat with The Monster, they provide modifiers and give The Monster its actions during the fight.

Monster Encounter

The Monster encounter is the final battle of the game, it involves all players using the stats and items they have gathered over the course of the game against the Monster and all of its drawn abilities.

Characters

Players are able to choose from a variety of different Characters, each with different stats and unique abilities.

<u>The Track Star</u>

While flying abroad to return from a competition, a plane crash strands the Track Star on the island. Use their speed to gather items and assist other survivors.

- Starting space: 13
- Starting Boon space: 3
- Stats: Strength: 2, Speed: 4, Smarts: 2, Supernatural: 2
- Skill: At the start of each turn, gain an Energy token.

<u>The Survivalist</u>

Prepared for anything, the Survivalist finds themself on The Island after taking a wrong turn in a rumored cursed forest. Fill your pack with items, and get ready to face The Monster.

- Starting space: 10
- Starting Boon space: 18
- Stats: Strength: 3, Speed: 3, Smarts: 2, Supernatural: 2
- Skill: At the start of the game, shuffle the item deck. Look through the deck from the top until you find a weapon, and draw it.

The Inhabitant

Having lived on The Island for their entire life, The Inhabitant knows the ins and outs of how it operates. As they've done for decades, they use their knowledge to mitigate or prevent bad things from happening.

- Starting space: 4
- Starting Boon space: 13
- Stats: Strength: 3 , Speed: 2, Smarts: 2, Supernatural: 3
- Skill: Before resolving an encounter, you may discard your encounter and draw a new one (Only do this once per round).

The Flight Attendant

Crashing on The Island during a flight like any other, The Flight Attendant was lucky to survive. However, something feels different. With The Island unlocking her latent psychic potential, she can see and alter the future.

- Starting space: 5
- Starting Boon space: 14
- Stats: Strength: 3, Speed: 2, Smarts: 1, Supernatural: 4
- Skill: As an action, you may check Supernatural. On a success, you may move any token on the board to an adjacent space.

The Researcher

The Researcher has dedicated their life to finding and understanding the unbelievable, and has finally found a way to reach The Island. They know they must grapple with challenges beyond their comprehension, but knowing is half the battle.

- Starting space: 20
- Starting Boon space: 7
- Stats: Strength: 2, Speed: 2, Smarts: 3, Supernatural: 3
- Skill: At the start of the game, gain a Preparation token.

The Lighthouse Keeper

After thick fog enveloped their tower, The Lighthouse Keeper was whisked away to a place even the most seasoned sailors haven't heard of. With their skills in repair, The Lighthouse Keeper is prepared to salvage what they can to protect themself.

- Starting space: 1

- Starting Boon space: 18
- Stats: Strength: 3, Speed: 1, Smarts: 4, Supernatural: 2
- Skill: Once per round, you may discard an item and draw a new one.

<u>The Businessman</u>

One minute they were sleeping soundly in their bed, and the next they felt the tide brushing against their ankles. Although out of their element, The Businessman's acumen and wealth provides them with a unique advantage among their fellow survivors.

- Starting space: 7
- Starting Boon space: 17
- Stats: Strength: 3, Speed: 2, Smarts: 4, Supernatural: 1
- Skill: Your item cap is 3. Draw an item at the beginning of every Event phase. You may trade with players one additional space away.

<u>The Doctor</u>

Returning home from doing surgery overseas, nothing could have prepared The Doctor for an emergency crash landing on The Island. Dedicated to keeping the other survivors alive, The Doctor will go out of their way to make sure everyone is in decent health.

- Starting space: 16
- Starting Boon space: 2
- Stats: Strength: 2, Speed: 2, Smarts: 4, Supernatural: 2
- Skill: As an action, you may heal three Life for yourself and an adjacent character.

<u>The Joe</u>

Driving through back roads on their way home from work, Joe found the route longer than normal. Much longer. Running out of gas, they stepped out of their truck and found themself on the island. Even with their truck mysteriously missing, Joe is ready to handle any situation.

- Starting space: 9
- Starting Boon space: 20
- Stats: Strength: 3, Speed: 3, Smarts: 3, Supernatural: 1
- Skill: You cannot die in one hit if you have at least 10 Life.

The Pirate

Setting sail sometime in the 18th century, The Pirate did their best to avoid the rumored windstorm over the Atlantic. After being blown into the Bermuda Triangle, they find themself out of place -- and out of time. No matter, their luck has always held true.

- Starting space: Any Beach tile
- Starting Boon space: 9
- Stats: Strength: 3, Speed: 2, Smarts: 3, Supernatural: 2
- Skill: At the start of your turn, roll a 6 sided die. On a 6, place a Special Item token on your space.

Actions

There are 7 actions that players can take during their turn. Players may only take two actions on their turn. Players may not take the same action twice during a turn. Once per turn, the current player also may move to an adjacent space before, between, or after their action(s).

Move - Move to an adjacent space. Then you may check Speed, and move up to X space(s), where X is the number of successes (5 or 6). Additionally, they may discard Energy tokens to move an extra space for each token discarded.

Rest - Heal two Life and obtain an Energy token.

Trade - Exchange any number of Items with a player on the same space or an adjacent space.

Prepare - If on a space with a Preparation token, check Supernatural. Success: Obtain the Preparation token from the board.

Scavenge - Check Smarts. Success: Draw three Items and pick one. Put the others back into the bottom of the Items deck. Fail: Draw an Item card. On a space with a Special Item token, skip the check and perform the Success effect. Then, remove the token from the board.

Character Action - Perform the ability on the other side of this card.

Item Action - Do as directed on the Item card. Players may take multiple Item actions in a single turn as long as they are from different Items.

Encounters

Encounter cards are drawn once per turn, and serve as a chance for players to use their Character's skills out of combat. Most encounters will give the player a skill check to pass, which will result in a negative effect if failed and a positive effect on success, although these cards are flexible and not every encounter works in the same manner.

Boons

Boons are cards with powerful positive effects only, and they can replace the Encounters. Once per game, if the player is on their Character's Boon space, they can choose to draw and resolve a Boon card instead of an Encounter card.

Monster Actions

Monster Action cards shared between everyone, and represent traits of The Monster. They are drawn during the Discovery phase at the end of the round. During combat with The Monster, they provide modifiers and give The Monster its actions during the fight. When all four Monster Actions are face up, begin the fight with The Monster.

Each card has an action that The Monster takes, and an additional Powered effect that makes the action stronger. Before fighting with the Monster, players may put their earned Preparation tokens onto Monster Action cards of their choice. Monster Actions with Preparation tokens on them do not apply their Powered effect.

Events

Events are a type of card which dictate which surprising things that happen on The Island. Some paths may get blocked off temporarily, or certain spots may become a sudden point of interest. Some island events are beneficial to players and some are not.

Stat Checks

Stat Checks are this game's system for determining an action's success or failure. Players will roll a modifiable number of D6's equal to their relevant stat total. The check is a success if they roll at least one 5 or 6. Checks are used primarily in combat and during events.

Character Movement

Characters can move around the island. They can make stat checks or spend an energy token to move further.

Items

Characters will collect items as they progress through the game to prepare for the final encounter. Items can function as equipment to be used in combat based on certain stats, or give players active and passive abilities that will affect their actions inside and outside of combat. Players will have the ability to collect and trade items between one another in order to optimize their build in preparation for the final Monster encounter. Players will also have the opportunity to analyze the evidence they have found to better prepare themselves for the final fight.

Full Ruleset

Quick Start Guide (*Read This First!)*

Reading is hard, and this rulebook is long! We recommend reading the entirety of the rules (excluding clarifications) before playing. However, if you prefer to read a bit and come back later, read the following sections over the course of the game:

Before starting, read:	During the game, read these when needed:	At the end of the third round, read:
- Objective - Setup - Game Structure - Character and Stats	- Checks - Tokens - Attacking - Death	- The Monster

Afterwards, read other sections as new concepts appear or if clarification is needed.

Components

- The Board
- Ten different colors of meeples
- Six card decks (Characters, Items, Events, Encounters, Boons, and Monster Actions)
- Four colors of tokens
    - Preparation - Red
    - Special Item - Orange
    - Energy - Yellow
    - Misc - Purple
- Ten twenty-sided dice
- Ten six-sided dice
- One four-sided dice

Story

Find Nowhere is a game about a group of people who are stranded on a mysterious island by a variety of means. The survivors must work together to prepare for the island's greatest threat: The Monster. Through research, gathering, and cooperation, the survivors must work as diligently as they can before time runs out.

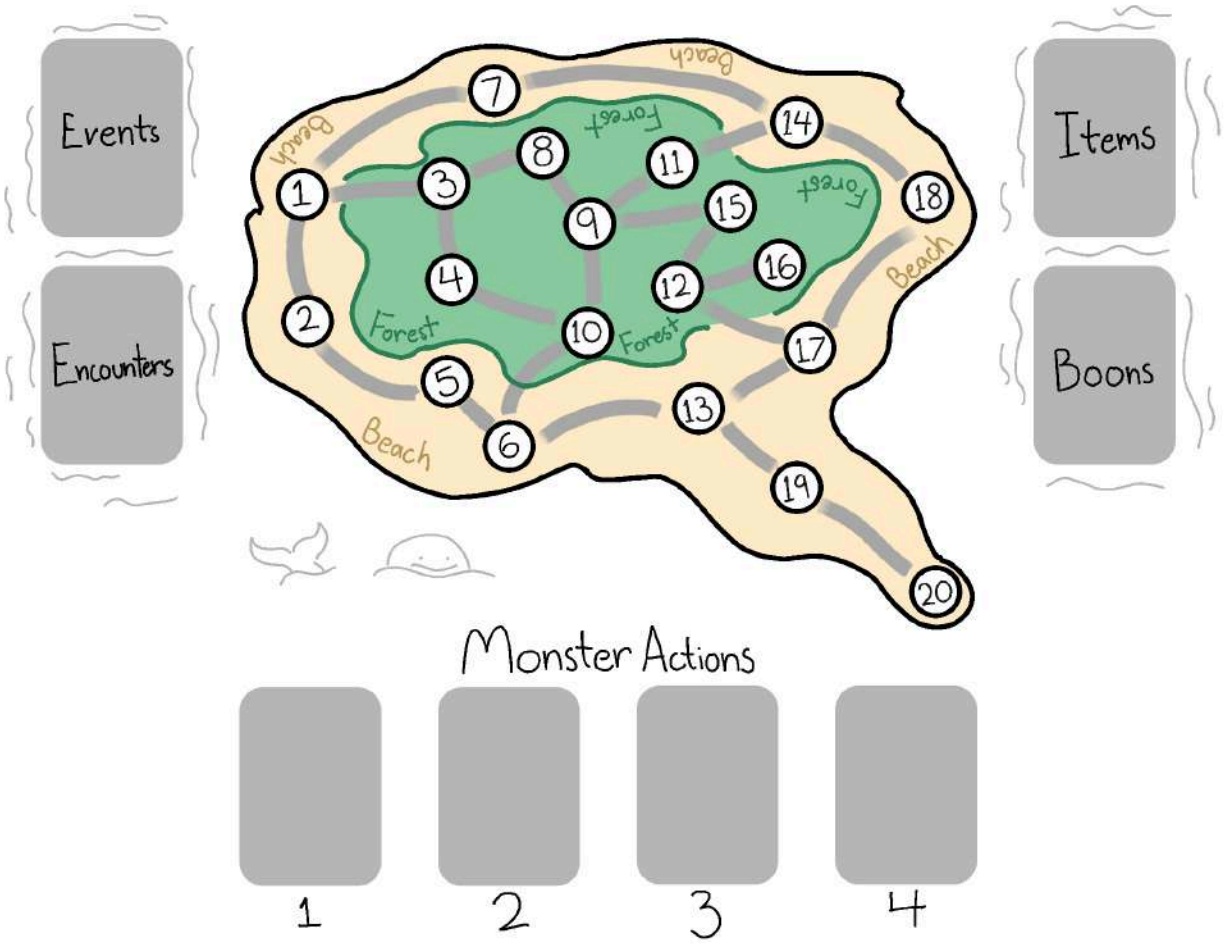
Objective

Resolve Events, collect Items, Prepare ahead, face Encounters, seek Boons, and defeat The Monster at the end of the third round.

Setup

Lay the board out and shuffle each deck. Place two Preparation tokens, and three Special Item tokens on different random spaces *(see Clarification: Randomizing)*. Draw four Monster Action cards face down onto their spaces in on the Board, and flip the first one face up.

Each player takes a Character card of their choice, a meeple of their choice, and a twenty-sided die. Set the twenty-sided die at twenty (this represents a Character's Life points). Each player places their meeple on the starting space indicated on their chosen Character's card.



Game Structure

The game takes place over the course of **three rounds**, each of which are made up of **three phases**, in the order below:

Event Phase:

Choose a player to draw an Event card, which either provides new obstacles to avoid or benefits to seek, and resolve it by performing the effect on the card. Discard the Event card after resolving it, unless otherwise stated. At the beginning of the **third round**, draw **two** Events instead of one.

Action Phase:

First, a player takes two **different** actions (*see back of Character cards/reference page*). Once per turn, the player also may move to an adjacent space before, between, or after their two actions.

After the action(s), the player may choose to draw and resolve a potentially risky but rewarding Encounter. Once per game, if their Character is on their Boon space (*indicated on the Character card*), that player may draw and resolve a Boon card, which are cards with powerful positive effects, instead of an Encounter card. Discard the Encounter/Boon card after resolving it, unless otherwise stated.

Then, the next player takes their actions. The phase ends once all players have taken a turn.

Discovery Phase:

Choose a player to flip the leftmost face-down Monster Action card face up. When all Monster Action cards are face-up, begin the fight with The Monster (*see The Monster*). If The Monster is defeated, the players win.

Characters and Stats

Each Character is represented by a Character card and a meeple. The Characters start with a maximum Life of twenty and a unique spread of stats. If a Character reaches zero Life, they die. To track a Character's Life, use twenty-sided dice.

Characters have an Item cap of **five**, meaning a Character can have up to five Items at a time. At the end of any of their turns (e.g. action, combat, and so forth), if a Character has more than five Items, discard Items until they have five or less remaining. Players may discard Items at any time.

STOP HERE ✋🛑 Come Back During The Game When Needed.

Checks

To resolve a check, roll a number of six-sided dice equal to the relevant stat on their Character card. Each die with a result of a **five** or **six** counts as a "hit". One or more hits during a check counts as a success, while zero hits counts as a failure.

Example: A card asks a player to check Smarts. Their character has a four in Smarts, so they roll four six-sided dice. They roll one, three, **five**, and **six**. They got two hits, and the check was successful.

Tokens

Special Item tokens allow players to succeed in their Scavenge actions without doing a check.

Preparation tokens are used to weaken the Monster Action cards (*see The Monster*). Players may only obtain four Preparation tokens over the course of the game. If a player would gain a fifth Preparation token at any time, they instead draw two Items.

Energy tokens can be obtained via the Rest action. Each character may hold a maximum of two Energy tokens at a time. Energy tokens may be spent to reroll a single die during skill checks (*see Checks*). They may also be spent with the Move action to move extra spaces.

An Event or Encounter may direct players to place a "new token" on one or more spaces. These tokens are representative, or reminders for something. When this happens, place a purple token where the Event or Encounter cards direct. Keep these cards nearby to help remember their effects.

Attacking

Attacks deal damage, and are done with a **Basic Attack** or a Weapon.

Weapons are a type of Item which provide additional ways to attack while fighting The Monster or during certain Encounters. To attack with a Weapon, do the check(s) listed on the Weapon, applying any modifiers listed on the card. Then, deal damage based on the description on the card, capped by the damage cap of the Weapon; if no damage cap is listed, the damage cap is unlimited.

Effects from Weapons DO NOT stack with each other.

(Note that not all Weapons will attack in this manner. Follow the text on the card.)

If the player does not have a Weapon in hand? No worries, all Characters have a **Basic Attack** ability. To make an unarmed Basic Attack, players make a Strength check that deals two damage for each hit (roll a **five** or **six**), with a **damage cap of three**.

Death

Characters die when they reach zero Life. However, death is not the end for our intrepid survivors! If a Character dies, turn its meeple over and place its Character card to

the side along with all of its Items. If a player's Character dies during their turn, their turn immediately ends. The player who controlled the Character picks a new Character, and sets them up as if they had just begun the game. If a Character reaches the overturned meeple and successfully performs a Smarts check, they can recover a number of Items from the dead character equal to a single six-sided dice roll. Then, remove the meeple from the board.

If a Character dies during The Monster fight, their player DOES NOT pick a new Character. They still win as long as The Monster is defeated.

STOP HERE ✋🛑 Come Back At The End Of The Third Round.

The Monster

The Monster is a mysterious creature that lives on The Island, survivors gradually discover its nature over the course of the game. Monster Action cards are shared between everyone, and represent traits of The Monster. They are revealed during the Discovery phase. During combat with The Monster, they provide modifiers and give The Monster its actions during the fight.

All survivors fight The Monster **at the end of the third round**, when all four Monster Actions are face-up.

Each Monster Action card has an action that The Monster takes, and an additional **Powered** effect that makes the action stronger. **Before the fight**, players may place their earned Preparation tokens onto Monster Action cards of their choice. Monster Action cards with Preparation tokens on them do not apply their **Powered** effect. During this time, players may give **one** of their Items to another player.

Fight Structure: The Monster goes first, attacking before the players. Then, players take turns in clockwise order attacking, starting with the current first player. The Monster attacks again each time two player turns have passed.

(e.g. with players A, B, C and **M** being the monster: **M**->A->B->**M**->C->A->**M**->B)

The Monster has **10 max Life per player**. (Track the Monster's Life using a number of twenty-sided dice.) To perform The Monster's attack, roll a four-sided die. Do the Monster Action corresponding to the roll (e.g. if a two is rolled, The Monster does the action

on the second Monster Action card). If the card's **Powered** effect is active, make sure to apply it.

Resolution

The game ends after a fight with The Monster at the end of the third round. If the Monster is defeated, the players win. If all Characters die, the players lose and The Island is victorious.

Reference

Game Structure

There are three rounds made up of three phases, in this order.

Event Phase:

Choose a player to draw and resolve an Event card. At the beginning of the **third round**, draw **two** Events instead of one.

Action Phase:

1) The current player takes **two** actions

2) Once per turn, the current player also may move to an adjacent space before, between, or after their two actions.

3) After the action(s), the current player may choose to draw and resolve a potentially risky but rewarding Encounter. If a Character is on their Boon space, that player may draw and resolve a Boon card instead of an Encounter card. (*Once per game)*

4) Then, the next player takes their turn.

Then, the next player takes their actions. The phase ends once all players have taken a turn.

Discovery Phase:

The first player flips the leftmost face-down Monster Action card face up. When all Monster Action cards are face up, begin the fight with The Monster. If The Monster is defeated, the players win.

Actions

During their turn, a player may take two different actions. There are seven actions a player can take during their turn. A player cannot do the same action twice on a given turn. A player may choose to pass one or both actions. Players may also move one space before, between, or after their two actions once per turn.

Rest: Heal two Life and obtain an Energy token.

Move: Players may move their character to an adjacent space. Then they may check Speed, and can choose to move an extra space for every hit they get. Additionally, they may discard Energy tokens to move an extra space for each token discarded.

Trade: Exchange any number of Items or Energy tokens with a player on the same space or an adjacent space.

Prepare: If a player is on a space with a Preparation token, check Supernatural. Success: Remove the token from the board and keep it with your Character.

Scavenge: Check Smarts. Success: Look at the top three Items, and choose one to draw. Put the other two cards on the bottom of the deck. Fail: Draw an Item card.

If a player is on a space with a Special Item token, they may skip the check and perform the Success effect. Then, remove the Special Item token from the board.

Character Action: If a character has an action listed on their card, they may perform that action as it is written.

Item Action: Do as directed on the Item card. Players may take multiple Item actions in a single turn as long as they are from different Items.

Events

Events change The Island, either providing new obstacles to avoid or benefits to seek. During the Event phase, one player draws an Event card and resolves the card by performing the effects listed on the card. Discard the Event card after resolving it, unless otherwise stated. Some Event cards may stay around, either permanently or for the specified number of rounds.

At the beginning of the third round, draw **two** Events instead of one.

Items

Items grant passive or active abilities to help prepare to fight The Monster. Characters have an Item cap of five, meaning a Character can have up to five Items at a time. At the end of their turn, if a player has more than five Items, they will have to discard Items until they have five or less remaining. Players may discard Items at any time.

Encounters

Encounters are risky but can reward players for exploring The Island. During the Actions phase, players may draw an Encounter and resolve the effects on the card. Resolve the card by doing the effects listed. Discard the card after resolving it, unless otherwise stated. Encounters usually require a check, which often provides a benefit when passed or a detriment when failed. Boons can replace Encounters during the Actions phase.

Boons

Boons are cards with powerful positive effects that replace a player's Encounter. Once per game, if a Character is on their Boon space (listed on the Character card), that player may draw and resolve a Boon card instead of an Encounter card. Discard the card afterwards, unless otherwise stated.

Monster Actions

Monster Action cards shared between everyone, and represent traits of The Monster. They are drawn during the Discovery phase at the end of the round. During combat with The Monster, they provide modifiers and give The Monster its actions during the fight. When all four Monster Actions are face up, begin the fight with The Monster.

Each card has an action that The Monster takes, and an additional **Powered** effect that makes the action stronger. Before fighting with the Monster, players may put their earned Preparation tokens onto Monster Action cards of their choice. Monster Actions with Preparation tokens on them do not apply their **Powered** effect.

Character Summary

In short summary, the Characters are as follows:

Track Star: High Speed and collect Energy tokens.

Survivalist: Starts with a Weapon.

Inhabitant: Controls Encounter randomness.

Flight Attendant: Controls token locations.

Researcher: Starts with a Preparation token.

Pirate: Finds treasure (Items).

Businessman: Draws Items, and can trade more easily.

Joe: Jack of all trades.

Lighthouse Keeper: Scraps Items for better ones.

Doctor: Heals them self and others.

Clarification

General

If any two effects directly conflict, negative effects take priority. For example, if an Item says you can do something but another Item says you cannot, you cannot do that something.

If a Character or enemy has an amount of Life you cannot represent/track with a single die, use multiple dice or use an alternative method to track the number.

Board

In regards to spaces, "highest" and "lowest" refer to the numbers on the spaces rather than their positions. Spaces are loosely numbered from top to bottom, then from left to right.

Spaces are adjacent if they are connected by a gray line.

Randomizing

When asked for a random space, roll a twenty sided dice and use the space with the same number as the result.

To randomize between players, each player rolls a six sided die. The player with the lowest roll (reroll on a tie) is chosen.

Energy

Multiple Energy tokens may be spent to reroll dice for the same check.

Multiple Energy tokens may be spent to move extra spaces during the same Move action.

Combat

Whether they have weapons or not, players may choose to do a Basic Attack during their turn in combat.

Items

Unless otherwise stated, the effects of non-weapon Items stack.

Players with more Items than their Item cap must discard the Items at the end of *any* of their turns, including during the Encounter phase and during combat.

Monster Actions

If a player would gain a fifth Preparation token, they instead draw two Items.

Playtests

Playtest 1

Number of Players: 4

Result:

This playtest started with confusion as players had not read the rules beforehand and ignored the quick start guide. Some players incorrectly placed tokens or meeples before realizing the proper mechanics. One player suggested making the type of check needed appear first in descriptions to improve clarity.

Throughout the game, players encountered several mechanical issues. They overlooked the dashing mechanic (an optional Speed check when moving) and struggled with rolling dice and performing checks, frequently referring back to the rules early on but quickly adapting. There was also confusion between the Special Item token effect and Scavenging—one player succeeded in a Scavenging attempt but mistakenly performed the effect of a Special Item token instead. Additionally, players underestimated the importance of items, which may have impacted their strategies.

During the Encounter phase, players decided that they would handle their Encounters simultaneously.

The Monster fight began about 1 hour and 10 minutes in, at which point players started to better understand mechanics like “prepared” and “surprise.” However, they had questions about the Monster’s location, the number of actions each player could take per turn, and whether actions like trading could be performed during combat. One player suggested having another board on the reverse side for Monster fights. Evidence cards were ignored during the Monster's actions, instead only focused on the Monster Action table.

The Monster was finally defeated after 1 hour and 30 minutes in the game. Although the playtest started with significant confusion, players gradually grasped the mechanics and began strategizing more effectively with their items.

Playtest Form Summary:

Players provided several suggestions for improving clarity and gameplay flow. One player recommended making the type of check required to appear first in descriptions, while another suggested adding an example of a check to the reference page for easier

understanding. A player proposed having another board on the reverse side specifically for the Monster fight to provide a more immersive space. Some found the game confusing at first but quickly adapted to the mechanics. They also noted that some wording needs clearer explanations and that there should be a better way to track important elements, such as player and Monster HP and the effects of certain cards. Overall, players enjoyed the experience, and wanted to play again when the final version of the game is done.

Playtest 2

Number of Players: 4

Result:

The playtest went relatively smoothly in key areas, but had some bumps along the road. They took a long time reading the Character cards and trying to understand the abilities. There is a summary of the Characters in the rules, so that section should be added to the Quick Start. There was confusion about phases and how players took turns during phases. During the Encounter phase, they thought each player had to do the Encounters at the same time. Players found the wording of certain items confusing, and there were 2 times where the wording did not work with the rules text of the game. After the end of the first round, players understood the rules. Players thought certain items were much stronger than others. Players sought out the Special Item tokens more than anything else. Players ended up with ~3 items each. Players laughed when something misfortunate happened. Players were strategizing about which goals they should go after. They did not particularly see the value in getting Evidence. Combat was time consuming and lacked real consequences. During the fight with the Monster, the players had to cross reference a lot of things to know the outcome. They defeated the Monster, and one Character died.The playtest took about an hour and twenty minutes to complete.

Playtest Form Summary:

Overall, players had fun going through the motions of the game. Players wished that the rules were more concise and were reorganized. They were unable to find the right place to answer some rules questions. They thought the fight with the Monster was slightly cumbersome, and that it should be a little more challenging. They thought there was a dominant strategy of getting items. Players thought it was fun to get unlucky, and did not think that the game was too difficult. The players also thought that some cards had too wordy of effects.

Playtest 3

Number of Players: 4

Result:

Overall, this playtest went very well for its allotted amount of time. Most players could not stay longer than an hour and some change, and in this time they only made it to round 2. Set up took longer than expected/necessary because players were confused about whether or not there was a certain person who was meant to go first or not. Eventually, they figured out it did not matter and started fighting about who would go first. One player also had never used a d20 before and was extremely confused by it. Other than that, players used the Quick Start set up and had no issues placing tokens and setting up the board. They found the color coding very helpful for this section.

Some players, like the people playing The Businessman and The Pirate were confused about how their abilities worked. Players also took some time to get used to the separate encounter round and how hits worked with checks, but they eventually got the hang of it. Players also went back and forth on whether or not you could take two of the same type of action during your turn since it was not specified in the rulebook, and they ended up playing duplicate actions during their turns. Multiple players got soft locked out of combat because they could not get a hit in, they did not seem frustrated with this but also didn't seem fun. It did make it so that combat was the most tense part of the game, which players did seem to enjoy. Players were also confused by the difference between the move and the dash actions.

By round 2, all players had totally forgotten about their Character's special abilities, two of which were abilities that gave tokens during the beginning of those players' turns. It was around the beginning of this round that players began to remark that they were "starting to understand this game" or "really get the hang of things". It was also during the end of the second round that they got their first piece of evidence, which they did not really seem to know what to do with. At this point, all but one of the players had lost a fourth or more of their health from various combat encounters.

Playtest Form Summary:

Just about every player remarked that either the rulebook was overwhelmingly large or that there was too much text to read. Players did appreciate the color coding the rules and benefited from it many times during their session. Players were also upset that they could not keep playing and had to attend prior engagements, they showed interest in playing again and were very curious about the evidence and Monster mechanics. This

group also wanted more combat encounters weirdly enough, each combat encounter really seemed to bring the group together so it made sense.

Playtest 1-3 Summary

We need to phrase abilities that give players stuff at the beginning of their turns differently in order to make it more obvious that you can take a whatever at the start of your turn. The rulebook needs to be shorted or pasted onto double sided paper. Rules also need to be reworded to make more sense to the average player. Special abilities and Evidence both need to be clearer in what they do and what their importance to the game is. More full playtests need to happen in order to get better feedback. It would also be very beneficial to have the same group of players play the game more than once, in order to see what mechanics need to be reworked because they have issues and not because they are not immediately understood by players.

Playtest 4

Number of Players: 3

Result:

The playtest went smooth once it started going, but it took quite some time to get up to speed. It was our first three player playtest, and only two players were new to the game, so they were left to set up the game blind while I observed. There were a number of spots in the rules that players got paused and tripped up on, and other spots where players would often naturally assume mechanics work differently than defined in the rules.

Once the game did really get going, players had a lot of fun. Each turn was faster than the last as players got used to the gameplay loop. The Monster Fight was very close, but the players won the fight each on the verge of dying. Both new players thought the Monster fight was exciting.

Playtest Form Summary:

Players liked the challenge of figuring out the best way to reach objectives and move around the board, but at times felt overwhelmed with choices.

Playtest 5

Number of Players: 4

Result:

This playtest went much better, as we were performing the playtest with experienced players who had already played the game before. Since players were already familiar with the game, setup was much quicker, and they got into the game within a few minutes.

There was some initial confusion about how encounters work, since we had changed how they worked since these players had last played the game. After learning that encounters were optional, most players did not go after encounters at all, which also helped the game go much faster. Players only did three encounters total in the game. All players played the game mostly by the rules, only making mistakes on a few things such as how special item tokens and scavenging work. There was some confusion on some cards, especially events and encounters whose effects persist for a while. Players were often confused at how long these effects persisted. Our group has already made sure to reword the cards to be more specific about this, we just didn't have time to reprint them for this playtest.

Observing this playtest, I was initially concerned that players weren't really going after preparation tokens at the beginning of the game. Players only have three turns to gain 4 preparation tokens in total, and they didn't go after any in the first turn at all. However, once reading the monster action cards after they began to be flipped over, they were reminded to pay more attention to getting preparation tokens. They were still able to get all four preparation tokens in the two turns they had left. This was very good to see, as it shows that every turn they used was very impactful, and they could accomplish a lot even in two turns. They still collected many items within these turns as well.

It was very cool to see players strategizing towards the end of the game, discussing how they should use their turns to best prepare for the monster. A new strategy developed this game, where players tried to use a combination of cards to continually prevent the monster from attacking. Luckily this was still up to chance, so it wasn't a completely broken strategy. Players got through the monster fight fairly easily, since they had all the preparation tokens, but monster attacks still felt impactful to players.

Playtest Form Summary:

Since these were experienced players, their responses were a lot more positive since they already understood the rules. Players still mentioned that the rules felt too long and that some cards were unclear, but besides that responses were fairly positive. Players liked the changes to the rules, and appreciated how much faster the game was.

Playtest 4-5 Summary

Overall, the balance and speed of our game has greatly improved from our first three playtests. It is still difficult for new players to understand all of the rules, so onboarding could definitely be improved. I think this combined with card clarity are the most important things we should be improving. We've already done work to rewrite cards to be more clear but have not reprinted them, so it's good to know we worked on the aspects players are confused about.

Competitive Analysis

The most similar game to Find Nowhere is undoubtedly Eldritch Horror, as it was our main inspiration for the gameplay loop, and we expect our game would have a very similar audience. Eldritch Horror, while not having publicized their sales records, has roughly 60,000 owned copies on BoardGameGeek, and its 8 purchasable expansions have a combined 100,000 owned copies as well on BoardGameGeek. Accounting for the prices of all the expansions and the base game, a total of roughly $8 million in revenue can be calculated from the BoardGameGeek reported sales alone. It can be assumed that the game sold much more than that to players who do not use BoardGameGeek.

Expected Development

We need 5 people for development.

Component	Quantity Per Box	Per-Unit Cost (2000/3000/5000/10000)				Tooling
Two Piece Box (365 x 300 x 98mm | 2.0mm cardboard)	1	$3.46	$3.20	$2.78	$2.58	$0
Game Board (700 x 570mm | 1/4 fold | 2mm cardboard)	1	$1.81	$1.69	$1.47	$1.30	$204
Paper Sheet (140 x 216mm)	6	$0.58	$0.41	$0.28	$0.18	$0
Cards (70 x 120mm | 300gsm bluecore)	117	$2.18	$1.89	$1.66	$1.48	$0
Dice (standard D6 | 12mm	10	$0.35	$0.34	$0.32	$0.31	$0

Component	Quantity Per Box	Per-Unit Cost (2000/3000/5000/10000)				Tooling
| acrylic)						
Dice (standard D4 | acrylic)	1	$0.09	$0.07	$0.06	$0.05	$0
Dice (standard D20 | acrylic)	10	$0.93	$0.91	$0.90	$0.89	$0
Wooden Meeple (16 x 16 x 10mm)	10	$0.29	$0.28	$0.26	$0.25	$0
Cloth Bag (150 x 120mm | Cotton)	6	$1.93	$1.89	$1.85	$1.83	$0
Plastic Disc (15 x 15 x 4mm)	46	$0.61	$0.59	$0.58	$0.57	$0
Assembly & QC	N/A	$0.07	$0.07	$0.07	$0.07	$0
Total Cost Per Box		$12.30	$11.34	$10.23	$9.51	$204
Total Cost Per Unit		$24600	$34020	$51150	$95100	$204

(Production Costs Estimates Made With: https://account.pandagm.com/estimate/edit)

Future Work

While we are proud of our current prototype, more work needs to be done to make the game complete. We think that the game's system is quite polished, and so it would likely need the least changes. Currently there is a relatively small set of cards for each deck, and so we would want to expand those decks to introduce more variety in the game. Along with that, the cards would need refining to make them more balanced with each other. This balance would have to work in multiple facets, because Items need to be balanced to be equally powerful, but Events need to be balanced to be equally exciting. The Monster fight also needs tuning, as some combinations of actions may be way too strong or way too boring. Generally, the fight is currently biased towards players, which can be good or bad. Ideally, we would make the fight more intense, but making sure it is not overturned will be quite difficult. Characters would also need a bit of tweaking, as some abilities have the potential to be way stronger than others.

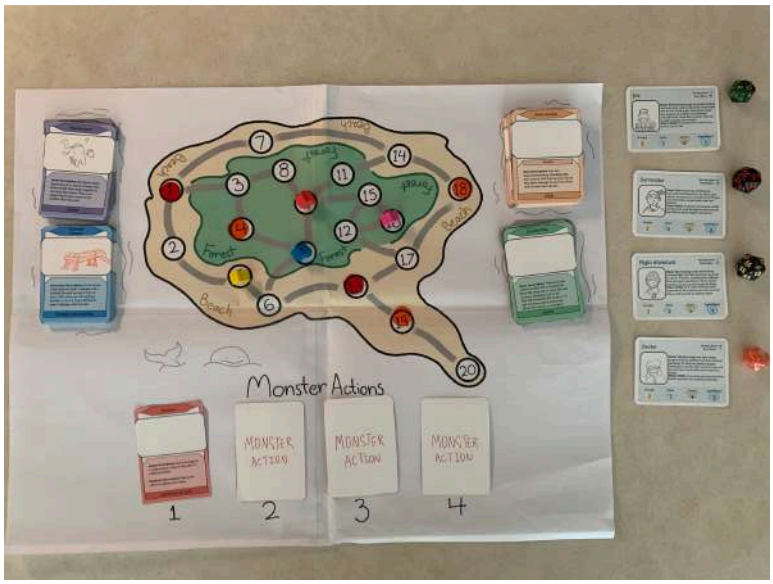
Largely, these problems will require a lot of playtesting to figure out. Which Items are taken more often than others? How do players react to each event? What Characters are picked most often? Which Characters/Items win most often? Does any card practically win/lose the game? How often do players win/lose? How much health do they start the fight at?

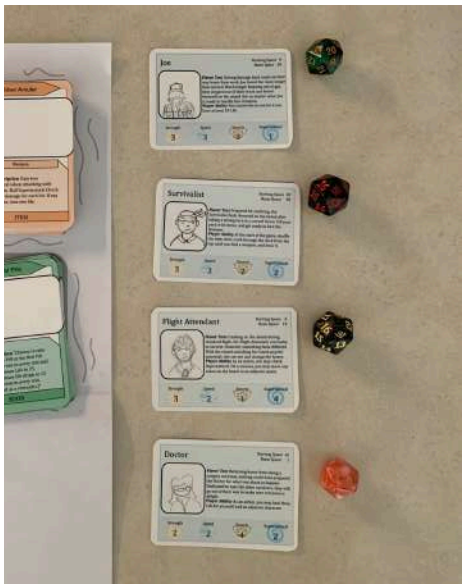
Thankfully, there are a lot of levers to pull to tune the experience. Through a lot of iteration and playtesting, each card could be balanced among its deck and each goal on board can be equally desirable.

Appendix

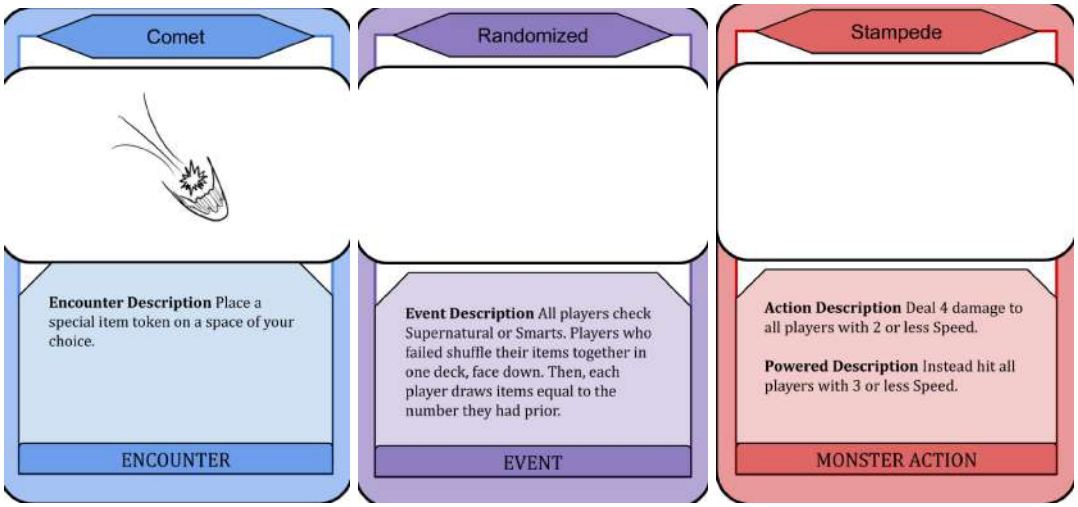
Prototypes

Set Up





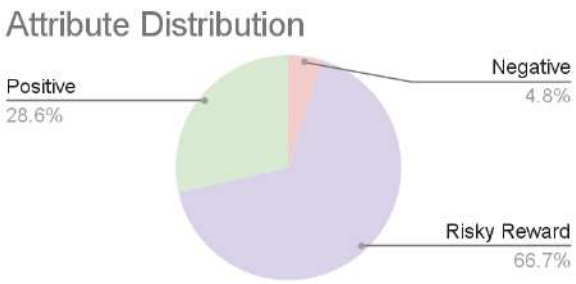
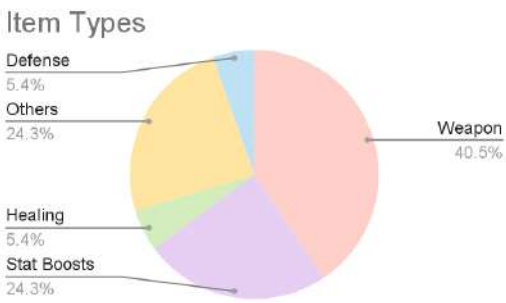
Sample Cards



Card Balance

Our spreadsheet for balancing and adding cards: Card Decks v2

Encounters



Items